



Apple AirPods Pro 2 Launch

Apple is rumoured to launch its AirPods Pro 2 featuring a new W2 chip in the first half of 2021. <http://digit.in/feb21-45>



Apple Watch Series 6

Apple debuts new Apple Watch Series 6 in TV commercial focussed on an on-wrist ECG feature. <http://digit.in/feb21-46>

Teardown: AirPods Max

Relatively repair-friendly nature that somewhat justifies the exorbitant price

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Unscrewing the drivers

There are 40mm Apple-designed drivers inside each earcup that are held down by a few screws, one of which is slightly harder to remove. With the screws removed, the drivers come right out and reveal a pair of repair-friendly spring contacts directly underneath them. Clearing out the drivers gives you enough room to move on to extract the battery. Surprisingly, both battery cells are housed within the right ear cup.

Easy first step of disassembly

The first step of disassembling these headphones is surprisingly simple. The ear cushions are held magnetically to the body of the headset and can be replaced by users without using any tools. That means you can mix and match different coloured earcups with different headsets! Fun! Underneath the ear cups, there are some Pentalobe screws, which, unfortunately, aren't extremely commonplace. Once the screws are loosened, a heat gun needs to be used and then the ear cup grilles can be gently pried away.

Extracting the power cells

Both battery cells are tethered together by a single cable and are fastened by screws, not adhesive. Yay for repairability! What's better is that they provide power via a single pop connector and there's no soldering here. The cells are made by Sunwoda and have a total capacity of 664 mAh and provide 2.53 Wh of total energy at 4.35V. This matches the Bose NC 700's 2.39Wh battery, however, the Sony WH-1000XM4's 4.1Wh battery outclasses it in this department.

